

Rather than adding to his debt by buying an expensive house, he worked in temporary positions as a traveling physician for two years. He and his wife lived in a half dozen different states while he worked in a variety of different practices. This enabled him to eliminate housing expenses by “living on the dimes of the hospitals and groups” he worked for. He said they would “put us up in apartments or hotels for a short period, and that way I was able to basically save every dollar I was paid. I had per diem for food, and I had lodging, and I was able to pay down my student loans while saving up for our future.”

Paige and Sam, the Los Angeles couple working toward FI on below-average salaries introduced in Chapter 4, found a simple solution. According to Paige, “living with roommates was huge.” This simple solution is common for college students and other young people, but there is a stigma associated with living with roommates as adults. Why is there no stigma to living paycheck to paycheck in houses or apartments that destroy wealth? The “adult thing” to do is to go out and buy or rent your own place. But there is probably nothing simpler, faster, or more practical than finding a roommate to cut housing and utility expenses.